

Habakkuk 2:20

But the LORD is in his holy temple: let all the earth keep silence before him.

- This verse is part of the LORD's response to Habakkuk's second petition and the next verse following it begins Habakkuk's prayer which we looked at a little in the study on [Habakkuk 3:19](#).

Habakkuk 2:18-20

[18] What profiteth the graven image that the maker thereof hath graven it; the molten image, and a teacher of lies, that the maker of his work trusteth therein, to make dumb idols?

[19] Woe unto him that saith to the wood, Awake; to the dumb stone, Arise, it shall teach! Behold, it is laid over with gold and silver, and there is no breath at all in the midst of it.

[20] But the LORD is in his holy temple: let all the earth keep silence before him.

- The LORD's response concludes with a description of the unprofitability (vanity, uselessness, emptiness) of graven images and idols.
- While we may not make statutes or wooden figures to worship and/or to pray to the warning about idols throughout the bible is still as much applicable today as it was back then. That is because idolatry begins in the heart.

The 2nd commandment in the old and new testament

Exodus 20:4-6

[4] Thou shalt not make unto thee any graven image, or any likeness of any thing that is in heaven above, or that is in the earth beneath, or that is in the water under the earth:

[5] **Thou shalt not bow down thyself to them, nor serve them:** for I the LORD thy God am a jealous God, visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children unto the third and fourth generation of them that hate me;

[6] And shewing mercy unto thousands of them that love me, and keep my commandments.

Matthew 22:37-40

[37] Jesus said unto him, **Thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy mind.**

[38] **This is the first and great commandment.**

[39] **And the second is like unto it, Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself.**

[40] **On these two commandments hang all the law and the prophets.**

IDOL'ATRY, noun [Latin idololatria. Gr. idol, and to worship or serve.]

1. The worship of idols, images, or any thing made by hands, or which is not God.
2. Excessive attachment or veneration for any thing, or that which borders on adoration.

VENERA'TION, noun [Latin veneratio.]

The highest degree of respect and reverence; respect mingled with some degree of awe; a feeling or sentiment excited by the dignity and superiority of a person, or by the sacredness of his character, and with regard to place, by its consecration to sacred services.

- Idolatry is not only the worship of graven images but includes excessive attachment or veneration for any *thing*.

- It's important to constantly keep an eye out for idols in our life and if needed get rid of them or put them in their proper place because they will always cause trouble with our relationship with God. If you don't think there are any idols in your life you can ask God to point them out for you and then wait for Him.
- In order to do so, we need to be able to identify idols in our life.

1 Samuel 15:22-23

[22] And Samuel said, Hath the LORD as great delight in burnt offerings and sacrifices, as in obeying the voice of the LORD? Behold, to obey is better than sacrifice, and to hearken than the fat of rams.

[23] For rebellion is as the sin of witchcraft, and **stubbornness is as** iniquity and **idolatry**. Because thou hast rejected the word of the LORD, he hath also rejected thee from being king.

- Here we learn that stubbornness is as idolatry. How can that be? When we stubbornly refuse the word of the LORD what are we doing? We mistakenly think that something else is more important or more valuable than what the LORD is offering (a few examples may be: an opinion, a person, or a thing).
- When we do that we are placing that person/opinion/thing *above* God and it becomes an idol.
- Thus, an idol is also anything that we place above God.

Colossians 3:5

Mortify therefore your members which are upon the earth; **fornication**, **uncleanness**, **inordinate affection**, **evil concupiscence**, and **covetousness**, which is idolatry:

- Here we learn that fornication, uncleanness, inordinate affection, evil concupiscence and covetousness are all idolatry.

Here's how easy the sin of idolatry is to fall into:

- We read the bible and God tells us to do something a specific way. A situation arises and we panic and ask a friend for advice and that advice is not how God tells us how to handle the situation. We take the friends advice and do what they told us. We just committed the sin of idolatry and the idol is the friend because we placed their opinion above God's.
- Say we like to play football but the games are only and always on Sunday. Do you think God will understand because they only play on Sundays? In the new testament the apostles preached the gospel on the sabbath (Saturday) in the synagogues (when the Jews met for worship and fellowship) and on Sunday they met for fellowship, prayer, and worship on Sunday. Biblical Christians today still follow the same example given to us in the new testament.
- Say we're walking down the street on a cold winter night. We have a coat and a cloak on to stay warm. A robber comes upon us and steals our cloak and then attempts to take our coat also but we resist and kick the robber to scare him away. We just committed multiple sins including idolatry (Lk. 6:29). In this case the idol is *ourselves*.

Habakkuk 2:20

But the LORD is in his holy temple: let all the earth **keep silence**^{H2013} before him.

- This verse is the last verse is God's response to Habakkuk.
- Notice how it begins with "but"?
- The "but" could be relative to the nearest previous topic (idolatry, Hab. 2:18,19) or it could be relative to the entire response (Hab. 2:2-19) to Habakkuk's second petition to God (Hab. 1:12-2:1).

H2013	הָשָׁבַח hâçâh, haw-saw'; a primitive root; to hush:—hold peace (tongue), (keep) silence, be silent, still.
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Numbers 13:30

And Caleb **stilled**^{H2013} the people before Moses, and said, Let us go up at once, and possess it; for we are well able to overcome it.

Judges 3:19

But he himself turned again from the quarries that were by Gilgal, and said, I have a secret errand unto thee, O king: who said, **Keep silence**.^{H2013} And all that stood by him went out from him.

Nehemiah 8:11

So the Levites stilled all the people, saying, **Hold your peace**,^{H2013} for the day is holy; neither be ye grieved.

Amos 6:10

And a man's uncle shall take him up, and he that burneth him, to bring out the bones out of the house, and shall say unto him that is by the sides of the house, Is there yet any with thee? and he shall say, No. Then shall he say, **Hold thy tongue**.^{H2013} for we may not make mention of the name of the LORD.

Amos 8:3

And the songs of the temple shall be howlings in that day, saith the Lord GOD: there shall be many dead bodies in every place; they shall cast them forth **with silence**.^{H2013}

Zephaniah 1:7 (cf. Matt. 22:1-14)

Hold thy peace^{H2013} at the presence of the Lord GOD: for the day of the LORD is at hand: for the LORD hath prepared a sacrifice, he hath bid his guests.

Zechariah 2:13

Be silent,^{H2013} O all flesh, before the LORD: for he is raised up out of his holy habitation.

Psalms 11:4

The LORD is in his holy temple, the LORD'S throne is in heaven: his eyes behold, his eyelids try, the children of men.

Psalms 115:3

But our God is in the heavens: he hath done whatsoever he hath pleased.

Psalms 132:13-14

For the LORD hath chosen Zion; he hath desired it for his habitation. This is my rest for ever: here will I dwell; for I have desired it.

Isaiah 6:1

In the year that king Uzziah died I saw also the Lord sitting upon a throne, high and lifted up, and his train filled the temple.

Isaiah 66:1

Thus saith the LORD, The heaven is my throne, and the earth is my footstool: where is the house that ye build unto me? and where is the place of my rest?

Isaiah 66:6

A voice of noise from the city, a voice from the temple, a voice of the LORD that rendereth recompence to his enemies.

Jonah 2:4

Then I said, I am cast out of thy sight; yet I will look again toward thy holy temple.

Jonah 2:7

When my soul fainted within me I remembered the LORD: and my prayer came in unto thee, into thine holy temple.

Ephesians 2:21-22

In whom all the building fitly framed together groweth unto an holy temple in the Lord: In whom ye also are builded together for an habitation of God through the Spirit.

Psalms 46:10

Be still, and know that I am God: I will be exalted among the heathen, I will be exalted in the earth.

Psalms 76:8-9

Thou didst cause judgment to be heard from heaven; the earth feared, and was still, When God arose to judgment, to save all the meek of the earth. Selah.

Zephaniah 1:7

Hold thy peace at the presence of the Lord GOD: for the day of the LORD is at hand: for the LORD hath prepared a sacrifice, he hath bid his guests.

Zechariah 2:13

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Remember from our previous study on Hab. 3:19 the context of the book of Habakkuk:

- Habakkuk finds out from God that the Babylonians (described by God as “terrible and dreadful” [Hab. 1:7](#)) are ordained by God for the judgment and correction of Israel and after Habakkuk learns of the terrible things to come, he writes a prayer in the form of a psalm about his confidence in God even in the midst of that most troubling news.
- A basic outline of the structure of the book is:
 - Habakkuk’s question(s) (1:1-4)
 - God’s response (1:5-11)
 - Habakkuk’s question(s) (1:12-2:1)
 - God’s response (2:2-20)
 - Habakkuk’s prayer (3:1-19)
- In Habakkuk’s second petition to God, among other things, he respectfully asks God how He can allow such evil things to happen and wonders why God hasn’t done anything about it heretofore.

WO/WOE, noun [G.]

1. Grief; sorrow; misery; a heavy calamity.
2. A curse.
3. woe is used in denunciation, and in exclamations of sorrow.

DENUNCIATION, noun

1. Publication; proclamation; annunciation; preaching; as a faithful denunciation of the gospel.
2. Solemn or formal declaration, accompanied with a menace; or the declaration of intended evil; proclamation of a threat; a public menace; as a denunciation of war, or of wrath.

A brief summary of God’s second response up to verse 20 (the “but”):

- Note that the word “woe” appears five times (2:6, 2:9, 2:12, 2:15, 2:19)
- Note also that carefully studying reveals that God is very likely still talking about the Babylons (Chaldeans 1:6) (gathereth unto him all nations, because thou has spoiled many nations, for the violence of the land, graven images, molten images, speaking to idols)
- [\(2:2-4\)](#) The LORD makes it clear that He is speaking about the future and verse 4 ends with “the just shall live by his faith” ([Rom. 1:17](#), [Gal. 3:11](#), [Heb. 10:38](#))
- [\(2:5-19\)](#) The LORD denounces many evils such as unrestrained desire (getting things at any cost including murder), taking things which are not rightfully your own (stealing, theft), murder and violence (men’s blood), evil covetousness (strong desire or eagerness for things, taking comfort in them, feeling secure based on possessions), lasciviousness, and idolatry.